

Flow matching and Diffusion Models

Lecture 3: Training the Generative Model.

flow matching.

flow model given by: $X_0 \sim p_{in}z$, $dX_t = u_t^\theta(X_t)dt$

neural network u_t^θ (θ parameters)

• Goal: $u_t^\theta \approx u_t^{\text{target}}$

• Flow matching loss: $\mathcal{L}_{FM}(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{unif}, x \sim p_t} [\|u_t^\theta(x) - u_t^{\text{target}}(x)\|^2] = \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, x \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\|u_t^\theta(x) - u_t^{\text{target}}(x)\|^2]$

$\downarrow$
uniform in $[0, 1]$ $u_t^{\text{target}}(x) = \int_{u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z)} \frac{p_t(x|z)p_{\text{data}}(z)}{p_t(x)} dz \leftarrow \text{intractable}$

conditional flow matching loss:

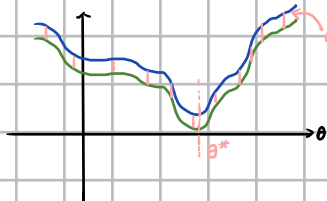
$$\mathcal{L}_{CFM}(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, x \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\|u_t^\theta(x) - u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z)\|^2] \leftarrow \text{tractable}$$

$$\mathcal{L}_{FM}(\theta) = \mathcal{L}_{CFM}(\theta) + C \rightarrow C \text{ is independent of } \theta, C > 0$$

① for minimizer θ^* of $\mathcal{L}_{CFM}$: $u_t^{\theta^*} = u_t^{\text{target}}$

$$\textcircled{2} \nabla_{\theta} \mathcal{L}_{FM}(\theta) = \nabla_{\theta} \mathcal{L}_{CFM}(\theta) \quad \nabla_{\theta} \mathcal{L}(\theta) = \left[\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \theta_1}, \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \theta_2}, \dots, \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \theta_n} \right]$$

SGD (stochastic gradient descent) the same



example: $\mathcal{L}_{CFM}$ for Gaussian conditional path.

$$p_t(\cdot|z) = \mathcal{N}(\alpha_t z, \beta_t^2 \text{Id}) \quad t: 0 \rightarrow 1 \quad \alpha_t: 0 \rightarrow 1 \quad \beta_t: 1 \rightarrow 0$$

$$u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z) = \left(\alpha_t - \frac{\beta_t}{\alpha_t} \frac{dt}{dt} \right) z + \frac{\beta_t}{\alpha_t} x$$

$$\epsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \text{Id}) \Rightarrow x_t = \alpha_t z + \beta_t \epsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(\alpha_t z, \beta_t^2 \text{Id}) = p_t(\cdot|z)$$

$$\mathcal{L}_{CFM}(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, x \sim \mathcal{N}(\alpha_t z, \beta_t^2 \text{Id})} [\|u_t^\theta(x) - \left(\alpha_t - \frac{\beta_t}{\alpha_t} \frac{dt}{dt} \right) z - \frac{\beta_t}{\alpha_t} x\|^2]$$

$$\left(\alpha_t - \frac{\beta_t}{\alpha_t} \frac{dt}{dt} \right) z + \frac{\beta_t}{\alpha_t} (\alpha_t z + \beta_t \epsilon) = \alpha_t z + \beta_t \epsilon$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \epsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \text{Id})} [\|u_t^\theta(\alpha_t z + \beta_t \epsilon) - (\alpha_t z + \beta_t \epsilon)\|^2]$$

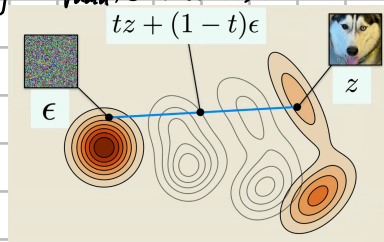
path from ϵ to z .



CondOT (Conditional Optimal Transport) probability path.

$$\alpha_t = t \Rightarrow \alpha_t = 1 \quad \beta_t = 1-t \quad \dot{\beta}_t = -1$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \epsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \text{Id})} [\|u_t^\theta(tz + (1-t)\epsilon) - (z - \epsilon)\|^2]$$



Algorithm 3 Flow Matching Training Procedure (here for Gaussian CondOT path $p_t(x|z) = \mathcal{N}(tz, (1-t)^2)$)

Require: A dataset of samples $z \sim p_{\text{data}}$, neural network u_t^θ

1: **for** each mini-batch of data **do**

2: Sample a data example z from the dataset.

3: Sample a random time $t \sim \text{Unif}_{[0,1]}$.

4: Sample noise $\epsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \text{Id})$

5: Set $x = tz + (1-t)\epsilon$

(General case: $x \sim p_t(\cdot|z)$)

6: Compute loss

$$\mathcal{L}(\theta) = \|u_t^\theta(x) - (z - \epsilon)\|^2 \quad (\text{General case: } = \|u_t^\theta(x) - u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z)\|^2)$$

7: Update the model parameters θ via gradient descent on $\mathcal{L}(\theta)$.

8: **end for**

proof: $\mathcal{L}_{FM}(\theta) = \mathcal{L}_{CFM}(\theta) + C$

$$\|a-b\|^2 = \|a\|^2 - 2a^T b + \|b\|^2 \quad (a, b \in \mathbb{R}^d)$$

$$\mathcal{L}_{FM}(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{unif}, x \sim p_t} [\|u_t^\theta(x) - u_t^{\text{target}}(x)\|^2]$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{unif}, x \sim p_t} [\|u_t^\theta(x)\|^2 - 2u_t^\theta(x)^T u_t^{\text{target}}(x) + \|u_t^{\text{target}}(x)\|^2]$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, x \sim p_t} [\|u_t^0(x)\|^2] - 2 \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, x \sim p_t} [u_t^0(x)^T u_t^{\text{target}}(x)] + \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, x \sim p_t} [\|u_t^{\text{target}}(x)\|^2] = C_1$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\|u_t^0(x)\|^2] - 2 \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, x \sim p_t} [u_t^0(x)^T u_t^{\text{target}}(x)] + C_1$$

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}} [g(t, x)] = \int \int (\text{probability density}) (\text{function value}) dx dt$$

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, x \sim p_t} [u_t^0(x)^T u_t^{\text{target}}(x)] = \int_0^1 \int (1-p_t(x)) (u_t^0(x)^T u_t^{\text{target}}(x)) dx dt$$

$$u_t^{\text{target}}(x) = \int u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z) \frac{p_t(x|z) p_{\text{data}}(z)}{p_t(x)} dz$$

$$= \int \int \int p_t(x) u_t^0(x)^T u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z) \frac{p_t(x|z) p_{\text{data}}(z)}{p_t(x)} dx dz dt = \int \int (p_t(x|z) p_{\text{data}}(z)) (u_t^0(x)^T u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z)) dx dz dt$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [u_t^0(x)^T u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z)]$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\|u_t^0(x)\|^2] - 2 \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [u_t^0(x)^T u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z)] + C_1$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\|u_t^0(x)\|^2 - 2 u_t^0(x)^T u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z) + \|u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z)\|^2 - \|u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z)\|^2] + C_1$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\|u_t^0(x) - u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z)\|^2] + \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [-\|u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z)\|^2] + C_1$$

$$= \mathcal{L}_{\text{CFM}}(\theta) + C_2 + C_1 = \mathcal{L}_{\text{CFM}}(\theta) + C$$

Score matching

marginal score function: $\nabla \log p_t(x) = \int \nabla \log p_t(x|z) \frac{p_t(x|z) p_{\text{data}}(z)}{p_t(x)} dz$

$$X_0 \sim p_{\text{init}}, dX_t = [u_t^{\text{target}}(X_t) + \frac{\sigma_t^2}{2} \nabla \log p_t(X_t)] dt + \sigma_t dW_t \Rightarrow X_t \sim p_t$$

score network: S_t^0 (0 parameters)

• Goal: $S_t^0 \approx \nabla \log p_t(x)$

• score matching loss (Denoising score match loss):

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{SM}}(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\|S_t^0(x) - \nabla \log p_t(x)\|^2]$$

conditional score matching loss:

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{CSM}}(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\|S_t^0(x) - \nabla \log p_t(x|z)\|^2] \rightarrow \text{tractable}$$

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{SM}}(\theta) = \mathcal{L}_{\text{CSM}}(\theta) + C \rightarrow \text{for } C \leq 0 \text{ of } \theta$$

① for minimizer θ^* of $\mathcal{L}_{\text{CSM}} = S_t^{0*} = \nabla \log p_t$

② $\nabla_{\theta} \mathcal{L}_{\text{SM}}(\theta) = \nabla_{\theta} \mathcal{L}_{\text{CSM}}(\theta)$

Example: Denoising score matching for Gaussian probability path.

$$\nabla \log p_t(x|z) = -\frac{x - \alpha_t z}{\beta_t^2}$$

$$\epsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(0, I_d) \quad x = \alpha_t z + \beta_t \epsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(\alpha_t z, \beta_t^2 I_d)$$

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{CSM}}(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\|S_t^0(x) + \frac{x - \alpha_t z}{\beta_t^2}\|^2]$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\|S_t^0(\alpha_t z + \beta_t \epsilon) + \frac{\beta_t \epsilon}{\beta_t^2}\|^2] = \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\|\frac{1}{\beta_t} S_t^0(\alpha_t z + \beta_t \epsilon) + \frac{\epsilon}{\beta_t}\|^2]$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\frac{1}{\beta_t^2} \|\beta_t S_t^0(\alpha_t z + \beta_t \epsilon) + \epsilon\|^2]$$

Algorithm 4 Score Matching Training Procedure for Gaussian probability path

Require: A dataset of samples $z \sim p_{\text{data}}$, score network S_t^0 or noise predictor ϵ_t^0

1: **for** each mini-batch of data **do**

2: Sample a data example z from the dataset.

3: Sample a random time $t \sim \text{Unif}_{[0,1]}$.

4: Sample noise $\epsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(0, I_d)$

5: Set $x_t = \alpha_t z + \beta_t \epsilon$

(General case: $x_t \sim p_t(\cdot|z)$)

6: Compute loss

$$\mathcal{L}(\theta) = \|S_t^0(x_t) + \frac{\epsilon}{\beta_t}\|^2$$

(General case: $= \|S_t^0(x_t) - \nabla \log p_t(x_t|z)\|^2$)

$$\text{Alternatively: } \mathcal{L}(\theta) = \|\epsilon_t^0(x_t) - \epsilon\|^2$$

7: Update the model parameters θ via gradient descent on $\mathcal{L}(\theta)$.

8: **end for**

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{CSM}}(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\frac{1}{\beta_t^2} \|\beta_t S_t^0(x_t) + \epsilon\|^2]$$

$$S_t^0(x_t) = -\frac{\epsilon_t^0(x_t)}{\beta_t}$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim \text{Unif}, z \sim p_{\text{data}}, \pi \sim p_t(\cdot|z)} [\frac{1}{\beta_t^2} \|\beta_t S_t^0(x_t) + \epsilon\|^2]$$

$$\Rightarrow \theta^* \text{ of } L(\theta) = \|S_t^0(x_t) + \frac{\varepsilon}{\beta_t}\|^2 \text{ equals to } \theta^* \text{ of } L(\theta) = \|\varepsilon_t^0(x_t) - \varepsilon\|^2$$

Stochastic sampling with diffusion models:

$$x_0 \sim p_{\text{init}} \quad dx_t = [u_t^{\text{target}}(x_t) + \frac{\sigma_t^2}{2} \nabla \log p_t(x_t)] dt + \sigma_t dW_t \Rightarrow x_t \sim p_t$$

plugin neural networks,

$$x_0 \sim p_{\text{init}} \quad dx_t = [u_t^0(x_t) + \frac{\sigma_t^2}{2} S_t^0(x_t)] dt + \sigma_t dW_t \xrightarrow{\text{after training}} x_t \sim p_t$$

Denoising diffusion models = Diffusion models with a Gaussian probability path. (our standard example) $N(\alpha_t z, \beta_t^2 I_d)$

Conversion formula for Gaussian probability path.

$$u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z) = (\beta_t^2 \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} - \beta_t \beta_t) \nabla \log p_t(\pi|z) + \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} x$$

$$u_t^{\text{target}}(x) = (\beta_t^2 \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} - \beta_t \beta_t) \nabla \log p_t(x) + \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} x$$

proof:

$$u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z) = (\alpha_t - \frac{\beta_t}{\beta_t} \alpha_t) z + \frac{\beta_t}{\beta_t} x = (\beta_t^2 \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} - \beta_t \beta_t) (\frac{\alpha_t z - x}{\beta_t^2}) + \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} x = (\beta_t^2 \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} - \beta_t \beta_t) \nabla \log p_t(\pi|z) + \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} x$$

$$\begin{aligned} u_t^{\text{target}}(x) &= \int u_t^{\text{target}}(x|z) \frac{p_t(\pi|z) p_{\text{data}}(z)}{p_t(x)} dz = \int [(\beta_t^2 \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} - \beta_t \beta_t) \nabla \log p_t(\pi|z) + \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} x] \frac{p_t(\pi|z) p_{\text{data}}(z)}{p_t(x)} dz \\ &= (\beta_t^2 \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} - \beta_t \beta_t) \int \nabla \log p_t(\pi|z) \frac{p_t(\pi|z) p_{\text{data}}(z)}{p_t(x)} dz + \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} \int x \frac{p_t(\pi|z) p_{\text{data}}(z)}{p_t(x)} dz \\ &= \nabla \log p_t(x) \quad \text{Bayes' Theorem: } \frac{p_t(\pi|z) p_{\text{data}}(z)}{p_t(x)} = p_t(z|x) \\ &\quad \int x \frac{p_t(\pi|z) p_{\text{data}}(z)}{p_t(x)} dz = x \int p_t(z|x) dz = x \\ &= (\beta_t^2 \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} - \beta_t \beta_t) \nabla \log p_t(x) + \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} x \end{aligned}$$

$$\Rightarrow u_t^0 = (\beta_t^2 \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} - \beta_t \beta_t) S_t^0(x) + \frac{\partial \alpha_t}{\partial t} x$$